

MOST IMMEDIATE

No.25022/24/2020-F.V/F.I
Government of India
Ministry of Home Affairs
(Foreigners Division)

Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium,
India Gate Circle, New Delhi - 110002

Dated : October 21, 2020

OFFICE MEMORANDUM

Sub: Visa & Travel restrictions in response to COVID-19 - Permitting certain categories of foreign nationals [including Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) & PIO Cardholders] to enter India - regarding

The undersigned is directed to refer to this Ministry's O.Ms of even number dated 30th June, 2020, 7th August, 2020, 17th August, 2020 and 2nd September, 2020 on the above mentioned subject. The Government has further considered the need for relaxation of visa & travel restrictions for more categories of foreign nationals who want to travel to India.

2. Accordingly, in supersession of this Ministry's O.M. dated 30th June, 2020, 7th August, 2020 and 17th August, 2020, it has been decided as follows:-

(i) Following categories of foreign nationals are permitted to enter India by water routes or by flights including those under the Vande Bharat Mission or 'air bubble' (bilateral air travel arrangements) scheme or by any non-scheduled commercial flights as allowed by the Ministry of Civil Aviation:-

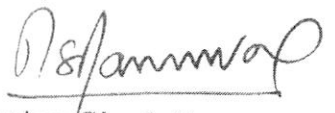
(a) All Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholders and PIO cardholders holding passports of any country.

(b) All foreign nationals intending to visit India for any purpose (including their dependents on appropriate category of dependent visa) **except those on Tourist Visa.**

(ii) All existing visas, **except electronic visas (e-Visa), Tourist visa and Medical Visa**, which remained suspended shall stand restored with immediate effect. If the validity of such visa has expired, the foreign national may obtain a fresh visa of appropriate category/sub-category from the Indian Mission/ Post concerned. In the case of Medical Visa (including visa for Medical Attendants), foreign nationals intending to visit India for medical treatment in emergencies may be granted Medical visa for appropriate period by the Indian Missions/ Posts. The condition of obtaining a visa will not apply to dependent family members of foreign diplomats/officials who are eligible for visa exemption in terms of bilateral visa exemption agreements or visa specific agreements entered into by India with various countries. Such foreign nationals covered by para 2 (i) (b) above will not be permitted to travel to India on the strength of any electronic visa (e-Visa) obtained earlier.



- (iii) In case any foreign national not covered by categories mentioned in (i) above is required to visit India urgently due to any family emergency, the Indian Missions/ Posts are authorized to issue single entry **X-Misc** visa for appropriate period. In such cases, the Indian Missions/ Posts may take a decision on grant of visa on a case to case basis on the merits of each case.
 - (iv) Nationals of Nepal and Bhutan are permitted to come to India from any country (including any third country).
 - (v) Any Indian national or a national of Nepal or Bhutan holding any type of valid visa of any country is permitted to travel from India to the country concerned provided there is no travel restriction for entry of Indian/ Nepalese/ Bhutanese nationals in that country. It would be for the airlines concerned to ensure that there is no travel restriction for Indian/ Nepalese/ Bhutanese nationals to enter the country concerned with the particular visa category before issue of tickets/ boarding pass to the Indian/ Nepalese/ Bhutanese passenger.
 - (vi) There will be no restriction on incoming passenger traffic into India through the authorised airport/seaport Immigration Check Posts for all categories of foreign nationals who are permitted to enter India or those who may be permitted to enter India in future. Such travel restrictions would also not apply to any movement of cargo or goods and supplies in any vehicle, aircraft, ship, train etc. along with their crew, sailor, driver, helper, cleaner etc. on any of the 107 Immigration Check Posts including the land ICPs. However, such restriction on incoming passenger traffic into India will continue to be in effect in respect of foreign nationals holding Tourist Visa.
 - (vii) In respect of quarantine and all other health/ COVID-19 related matters, guidelines of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare shall be strictly adhered to.
3. Instructions contained in this Ministry's O.M. of even number dated 2nd September, 2020 (Copy enclosed) regarding entry of certain categories of Tibetan migrants will continue to be in effect.
4. This issues with the approval of the Competent Authority.


(Pratap Singh Rawat)

Under Secretary to the Government of India

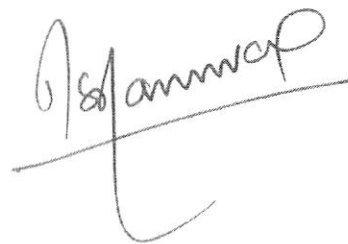
☎: 23077506

To

1. Foreign Secretary

Contd.....3

2. Ministry of Civil Aviation [**Kind Attn: Shri Pradeep Singh Kharola, Secretary**], Rajiv Gandhi Bhawan, Block B, Safdarjung Airport Area, New Delhi -110 003
3. Directorate General of Civil Aviation (**Kind Attn: Shri Arun Kumar, Director General**) .
4. Bureau of Immigration [**Kind Attn: Shri Rajeev Ranjan Verma, Additional Director**], East Block, R.K. Puram, New Delhi
5. Joint Secretary (DM), Ministry of Home Affairs
6. Ministry of External Affairs [**Kind Attn: Shri Devesh Uttam, OSD(CPV)**], Patiala House Annexe, New Delhi

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Devesh Uttam', with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

MOST IMMEDIATE

No.25022/24/2020-F.V/F.I (Pt.)

Government of India
Ministry of Home Affairs
(Foreigners Division)

Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium,
India Gate Circles, New Delhi - 110002

Dated : September 02, 2020

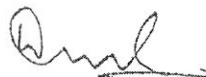
OFFICE MEMORANDUM

Sub: Visa & Travel restrictions in response to COVID-19 - Permitting certain categories of foreign nationals to enter India

The undersigned is directed to refer to this Ministry's O.M. of even number dated 30th June, 2020, 7th August, 2020 and 17th August, 2020 on the subject mentioned above and to say that the Government has further considered the need for relaxation of visa & travel restrictions for more categories of foreign nationals who want to travel to India.

2. Accordingly, in addition to the categories of foreign nationals who are permitted to enter India vide this Ministry's O.M. of even number dated 30th June, 2020, 7th August, 2020 and 17th August, 2020, it has been decided to permit Tibetan migrants who have their residence in India and holding Certificate of Identity issued by the Ministry of External Affairs and Return Visa to enter India. This is subject to the condition that such Tibetan migrants should have been registered with the FRRO/FRO concerned. Their Return Visa shall stand restored with immediate effect to facilitate their entry into India. However, if the validity of such visas has expired, they may obtain a fresh Return Visa from the Indian Missions/Posts concerned. It has also been decided that the existing restrictions on incoming passenger traffic into India through the Immigration Check Posts will not apply in respect of these foreign nationals. However, in respect of quarantine and all other health/COVID-19 related matters, guidelines of the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare shall be adhered to.

3. This issues with the approval of the Competent Authority.


(Pramod Kumar)
Director (Foreigners)
☎: 23077508

To

1. Foreign Secretary (Shri Harsh Vardhan Shringla).
2. Ministry of Civil Aviation [Kind Attn: Shri Pradeep Singh Kharola, Secretary], Rajiv Gandhi Bhawan, Block B, Safdarjung Airport Area, New Delhi -110 003
3. Bureau of Immigration [Kind Attn: Shri Rajeev Ranjan Verma, Additional Director], East Block, R.K. Puram, New Delhi
4. Ministry of External Affairs [Kind Attn: Shri Devesh Uttam, OSD (CPV)], Patiala House Annexe, New Delhi
5. Joint Secretary (DM), Ministry of Home Affairs

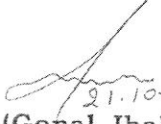
No.26011/Misc./83/2020-OCI
Government of India
Ministry of Home Affairs
(Foreigners Division)

Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium,
India Gate Circle, New Delhi – 110002

Dated : October 21, 2020

ORDER

In supersession of this Ministry's Orders of even number dated 13.03.2020, 16.04.2020, 05.05.2020, 12.06.2020 and 07.08.2020, the Central Government, in exercise of the powers conferred by clause (a) of sub-section (2) of section 3 of the Foreigners Act, 1946 (31 of 1946), being of the opinion that it is necessary and expedient in public interest to do so, hereby specifies that the right of multiple entry lifelong visa facility granted for any purpose in terms of the Notification S.O. 542(E) dated 11th April, 2005 issued by the Ministry of Home Affairs shall stand restored with immediate effect to all persons registered as Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) cardholders under section 7A of the Citizenship Act, 1955 (57 of 1955).


21.10.20
(Gopal Jha)

Under Secretary to the Government of India
☎: 23075329

Copy to :

1. Foreign Secretary
2. Ministry of Civil Aviation [**Kind Attn: Shri Pradeep Singh Kharola, Secretary**], Rajiv Gandhi Bhawan, Block B, Safdarjung Airport Area, New Delhi – 110 003
3. Directorate General of Civil Aviation (Kind Attn: **Shri Arun Kumar, Director General**) .
4. Bureau of Immigration [**Kind Attn: Shri Rajeev Ranjan Verma, Additional Director**], East Block, R.K. Puram, New Delhi
5. Joint Secretary (DM), Ministry of Home Affairs
6. Ministry of External Affairs [**Kind Attn: Shri Devesh Uttam, OSD(CPV)**], Patiala House Annexe, New Delhi